The 6:15

WEDNESDAY · NOVEMBER 4, 2026 NO. 36

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Wed 11/4 (today)	Qualcomm reports FQ4/FY26 after close, 4:45p ET call. Caterpillar Q3 also expected today — neither verified yet **[flag]**.
Fri 11/6	October jobs report (NFP), 8:30a ET.
Mon 11/9	Veterans Day observed — markets open, bond market closed.
Tue 11/10	October CPI, 8:30a ET.
Fri 11/13	October PPI, 8:30a ET.

No FOMC in this window (Fed holds 3.50%–3.75%; next decision Dec. 9). OPEC+'s Nov. 1 output decision still unconfirmed this run **[flag]**. No frontier AI release, rocket launch, or large VC round cleared verification in the last 24–48h.

METRICS · ~5:10A ET UNLESS NOTED

Equities (Tue close)	S&P 500 7,568.92 (+0.36%); Nasdaq Comp. 25,372.01 (+0.83%); Dow 51,786.72 (−0.38%)
Futures (Wed pre-mkt)	S&P +0.79%; Nasdaq-100 +0.69%; Dow +1.19% — post-election relief rally
VIX	18.52 (−11.09%), ~5:02a — down from Mon.'s 21.27 close
Brent / WTI	Brent $102.66–$104.15 depending on source **(flag, ~$2 spread this hour)**; WTI $95.74 (−0.36%). Spread ~$7
10Y / 2Y / 30Y	10Y 4.952% (Tue close); 2Y/30Y not independently confirmed **[flag]**
DXY	101.31 (−0.55%) — lowest since late Sept. per CNBC
Gold	low $4,000s (+2.6% to +2.9%, sources agree on direction/magnitude, not exact tick)
Asia (Wed close)	Nikkei −1.4% to −1.68% (sources diverge); Hang Seng +1.5–1.67%; Shanghai +2.2%; Kospi +0.6%

Europe	Not independently confirmed this run [flag]
Retail gas (AAA)	$4.1239/gal nat'l avg., down from $4.1837 (10/31)

Brent/WTI: ICE/NYMEX front-month, no settle available at press time — range given. Equities: Yahoo Finance. Rates: CNBC/Yahoo. Gold/DXY cross-checked against CNBC.

HORMUZ COUNTERS — STRAITS.LIVE, 04 NOV 10:16Z

Status	Closed to commercial shipping since Feb. 28 — Day 248
Transits	2/day (25 Oct, IMF PortWatch) vs. 85/day baseline — 10 days stale
Dark tankers (24h)	161/232 screened, 69.4% — flat vs. Tue.'s 69.1%
War-risk premium	~32.0x pre-crisis — estimate 28 days stale
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±7 (Extreme, flat); Escalation Forecast 58±10 (Elevated, −1)

Transit count (IMF PortWatch, AIS-confirmed crossings only), dark-tanker screen (AIS-silence proxy) and war-risk premium (insurance-market estimate) measure different things on different cadences — straits.live's "closed" verdict is its own composite, not an average of the three.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Bednar qualifying offer ($23.15M) still "expected," not confirmed issued [flag]
Knicks	Idle since Mon. win over Brooklyn (3-4); host Chicago tonight, not yet played
Northwestern	No game since Oct. 31 loss at Oregon; next Sat. 11/7 vs. Iowa, home

LEAD

ELECTIONS · MARKETS

Democrats sweep the House and Senate, delivering the midterm rebuke markets had already priced — and settling, for now, the question the Qeshm strikes raised about Election Day

The projection arrived in two stages overnight. The AP called the Senate for Democrats late Tuesday, a seven-seat swing that flipped Ohio, Iowa, South Carolina, Maine, North Carolina, Kansas and Texas; the House call followed early Wednesday, completing a clean sweep of both chambers. Democrats needed a net gain of four Senate seats and three House seats to take control; they cleared both marks comfortably enough that networks called the chambers before several individual races were fully tabulated. House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries is now positioned to become the first Black speaker in the chamber's history, pending the incoming House's own vote to formalize it. Coverage frames the result as a rebuke of the administration, tying it to two threads this brief has carried for weeks: persistent voter anger over prices, and the Iran war — including Monday night's Qeshm Island strikes, which landed hours before polls opened despite Trump's own repeated pledge not to hit Iran before the vote (issue No. 35).

The market's reaction is the mechanism worth sitting with. A Democratic sweep of Congress is, on its face, the more "disruptive" outcome for an administration's legislative agenda — and risk assets rallied anyway. VIX collapsed 11% overnight to 18.52, S&P and Nasdaq futures both pushed roughly 0.7%–0.8% higher pre-market, and Dow futures jumped over 1.2%, even as the cash indices had already closed mixed Tuesday (S&P +0.36%, Nasdaq +0.83%, Dow −0.38%). Read: markets are pricing divided government as a check on fiscal and trade unpredictability rather than as gridlock risk — the same framing investors apply after most midterms, but with extra weight here given how much of this year's volatility has been administration-policy-driven rather than cyclical. The dollar sold off on the result (DXY −0.55% to 101.31, lowest since late September per

CNBC) and gold caught the other side of that trade, rallying roughly 2.6%–2.9% to the low $4,000s — a textbook risk-off-into-a-weaker-dollar move that is unusual paired with an equity futures rally, and points to investors buying insurance against political uncertainty even as they add risk.

Oil is the one market still digesting Monday night's strikes rather than the election. Brent sources disagree by nearly $2 within the same early-morning hour — one feed's $102.66 against straits.live's own $104.15 read minutes earlier — which this brief reads as a market still searching for a level after Monday's 7.4% plunge on de-escalation hope collided with the Qeshm strikes' re-escalation risk (issue No. 35). The straits.live dark-tanker screen, meanwhile, is essentially unchanged at 69.4% versus Tuesday's 69.1% — not the second consecutive jump that would confirm a trend tied to the strikes, just a plateau at an elevated level the site itself cautions could be ambient AIS noise. For the investor reader, the actionable split is: election risk is now resolved and priced, with equities and vol both reflecting relief; Hormuz risk is not resolved, sits exactly where Monday night left it, and is the variable still capable of moving crude and the inflation path from here.

Watch: any further Iranian response to the Qeshm strikes; whether Wednesday's Brent session actually settles; and Friday's jobs report, the first hard data point the new Congress will have to react to.

POLITICS

Beyond the Lead: the seven flipped Senate seats (Ohio, Iowa, South Carolina, Maine, North Carolina, Kansas, Texas) span both the traditional battlegrounds this brief tracked all cycle (Iowa's Hinson-Turek race, North Carolina's Cooper-Whatley race) and states markets

weren't pricing as competitive, which is part of why the margin surprised to the upside for Democrats relative to the tighter pre-election market odds flagged in issue No. 35 (Kalshi/Polymarket had the House near 92%–92.5% but the Senate closer to even money on a stale read). Governor races were not independently confirmed this run — exit coverage flagged Kansas and Ohio as newly competitive late in the cycle, but no verified call reached this brief's research window. The fabricated-polling episode (Wedgewood Polls, exposed Oct. 20) remains uncorrected and, with the election now decided, is likely to fade as a live story rather than resolve.

ECONOMICS

Friday's October jobs report (8:30a ET) is now the first hard macro data point arriving under a newly divided Congress, and this brief could not verify a consensus forecast this run. Tuesday's JOLTS release (September data, due 10:00a ET) did not surface a confirmed actual figure in this run's research in time for press — flagged not verified rather than estimated. No FOMC meeting intervenes before Dec. 9; CPI follows Nov. 10, PPI Nov. 13. Retail gas extended its decline to $4.1239/gal nationally (11/4), continuing a weeks-long slide that predates both the election and Monday night's strikes.

BUSINESS

Pfizer's Q3 2026 results, filed via SEC 8-K, showed revenue of roughly $16.6 billion (about flat year over year on an operational basis) with reported diluted EPS of $0.56 and adjusted diluted EPS of $0.87; excluding Comirnaty and Paxlovid, revenue grew 7% operationally. The company raised full-year guidance to $62.0–$64.0 billion revenue and $2.95–$3.05 adjusted EPS, and announced Cecile

Guegan as the new CFO. AMD's Q3, also filed via 8-K, beat expectations: revenue of $13.4 billion (+45% y/y, a record), gross margin 54%, GAAP diluted EPS $1.46 and non-GAAP EPS $2.09 against a Street consensus near $1.88/$13.09B. Data Center revenue grew 97% y/y on Instinct GPU and EPYC CPU sales; CEO Lisa Su said growth should accelerate further in Q4 as Helios and "Venice" production scales. Qualcomm reports fiscal Q4/FY2026 after Wednesday's close; Caterpillar's Q3 print was also expected this week but this brief could not independently verify either company's actual results in time for press.

TECHNOLOGY

AMD's record quarter (above) is this issue's technology story as much as a business one: a 97% y/y jump in Data Center revenue on Instinct GPU demand is the clearest hard data point yet this week on AI-infrastructure spending holding up, arriving the same week Tuesday's Asia session showed chip-heavy markets still jumpy (last issue's Kospi/Kosdaq/Taiwan selloff, issue No. 35) before Wednesday's broad Asia rally on the US election result overrode that positioning. No frontier AI model release, funding round, or rocket launch cleared this brief's verification bar this run.

GEOPOLITICS

No standalone development beyond the Lead and Iran & Hormuz sections this issue — the election and the Qeshm strikes are this week's whole geopolitical story.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Lead and Board: this brief has no confirmed update on the Qatar/Pakistan-mediated framework (Iran halting shipping attacks in exchange for the US lifting its naval blockade) since issue No. 35's reporting, nor any confirmed Iranian military response to Monday night's Qeshm strikes as of this run. The dark-tanker screen holding flat at 69.4% (vs. Tuesday's 69.1%) is this issue's one data point — not yet the second straight jump that would confirm a trend, but not a retreat either. Everything else this brief flagged as uncorroborated in issue No. 35 — Iranian state media's tanker-fire and mine-strike claims — remains uncorroborated, with no new reporting surfacing this run.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over (eliminated Oct. 7, ALDS). Bednar qualifying-offer decision still pending.
Knicks	3-4, idle since Monday's win over Brooklyn; host Chicago tonight.
Northwestern	3-6 after the Oct. 31 loss at Oregon; next Sat. 11/7 vs. Iowa, home.

Continuity. Watch for next issue: any confirmed Iranian response to the Qeshm strikes or mediation update; Wednesday's actual Brent/WTI settle; Qualcomm's and Caterpillar's actual prints; Friday's jobs report; whether the dark-tanker screen breaks its ~69% plateau; Bednar qualifying-offer confirmation; unverified governor-race calls (Kansas, Ohio).

Unverified figures are marked in red: Wednesday's settled Brent/WTI level; 2Y/30Y Treasury yields; Europe's Wednesday levels; September JOLTS actual; October jobs consensus; OPEC+'s Nov. 1 decision; Caterpillar's/Qualcomm's actual results; governor-race calls; Bednar qualifying-offer status. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.